Executive Analytics Report: Parental Perceptions of Youth Online Gaming

Prepared for: YourDOST Recruitment Evaluation

Dataset: Primary Survey ($N = 100$ total respondents; $n = 67$ active gaming households)

Deliverables: SQL Analysis, 1-Page Infographic (yourdost_infographic_kpi.png), and Executive Summary

1. Project Context & Objectives

Online gaming has evolved from a solitary pastime into a central fixture of modern youth culture and a major source of domestic tension. To support **YourDOST** in crafting effective digital wellness programs, this analysis examines primary survey responses from parents to uncover their attitudes, fears, enforcement patterns, and household conflict dynamics regarding online gaming.

The analytical goal is to move beyond superficial observations (e.g., *"parents worry about screen time"*) to identify structural patterns, cognitive paradoxes, and actionable intervention points.

2. Analytical Methodology & SQL Architecture

To ensure rigorous analysis under tight operational constraints, the raw 100-row survey dataset was imported into a relational database (gaming_survey_raw) and standardized into a clean analysis view (gaming_survey_clean).

Key Data Engineering Steps:

1. **Null Handling for Non-Gamers:** Households where children do not play games ($N = 33$) leave survey-specific gaming questions blank (NULL). These were explicitly separated from active gaming households ($N = 67$) to prevent percentage dilution.
2. **Datatype Standardization:** Timestamps were parsed into standard DATETIME formats, and string-enclosed responses ("True" / "False") were cast into boolean flags.
3. **Core SQL Query Structure:** Aggregations were executed using conditional summing (CASE WHEN ... THEN 1 ELSE 0 END) grouped by active gaming status.

3. Key Findings & SQL-Derived Insights

Insight 1: The Fear Hierarchy — Addiction and Academics Overwhelm Physical Concerns

Parents do not fear all aspects of gaming equally. When analyzing high-fear responses among active parents ($N = 67$), behavioral dependency and future derailment far outweigh physical health concerns:

- **Gaming Addiction: 56.7%** (38/67 parents) report high fear.
- **Academic Decline: 52.2%** (35/67 parents) report high fear.
- **Adverse Health Effects: 41.8%** (28/67 parents) report high fear.
- **Inappropriate Content: 40.3%** (27/67 parents) report high fear.
- **Aggressive Behavior: 31.3%** (21/67 parents) report high fear.

SQL Verification Snippet:

SQL

```
SELECT
  ROUND(SUM(CASE WHEN fear_addiction = 'High fear' THEN 1 ELSE 0 END) * 100.0 / COUNT(*), 1) AS pct_addiction
FROM gaming_survey_clean
WHERE kids_play_games != 'No';
```

- **Interpretation:** Parents view addiction as the root catalyst that subsequently triggers poor school performance. Physical aggression and violent behavior rank lowest, indicating parents recognize gaming as an indoor, sedentary distraction rather than an incubator for physical violence.

Insight 2: The Dual-Perception Paradox — Stress Relief vs. Overwhelming Distraction

Parents experience severe cognitive dissonance regarding the psychological role of games:

- While **55.2%** (37/67 parents) agree that gaming serves as a valid **stress-buster**, an overwhelming **86.6%** (58/67 parents) simultaneously classify it as a **major distraction**, and **67.2%** fear dangerous consequences.

SQL Verification Snippet:

SQL

```
SELECT
  ROUND(SUM(CASE WHEN stmt_distraction IN ('Agree', 'Strongly Agree') THEN 1 ELSE 0 END) * 100.0 / COUNT(*), 1) AS pct_distraction
FROM gaming_survey_clean
WHERE kids_play_games != 'No';
```

- **Interpretation:** Parents acknowledge the emotional release games provide to stressed youth after school, yet feel powerless against gamified retention loops that derail study routines.

Insight 3: Domestic Fallout — Gaming as a Daily Household Battleground

The survey reveals that gaming friction is not isolated to a few extreme households; it is widespread across more than half of active families:

- **Family Frustration: 62.7%** (42/67 parents) report medium-to-high frustration.
- **Arguments & Conflicts: 55.2%** (37/67 parents) report regular household arguments.
- **Relationship Strain: 53.7%** (36/67 parents) note tangible strain in the parent-child relationship.

4. Strategic Implications for YourDOST

1. **Shift Messaging from "Bans" to "Boundaries":** Rigid, unilateral device bans generate intense domestic friction. YourDOST should coach parents on collaborative boundary-setting (e.g., negotiated time limits and exam windows).
2. **Promote Digital Empathy:** Because parents experience a stress-relief vs. distraction paradox, counseling sessions should help parents understand *why* children turn to games, treating gaming habits as indicators of underlying stress rather than willful disobedience.

5. Limitations & Data Biases

- **Sample Size ($N = 100$, Active $n = 67$):** While sufficient for exploratory directional insights, findings should be validated against larger, nationally representative cohorts.
- **Geographic & Socioeconomic Skew:** Respondents are predominantly concentrated in Tier-1 urban centers and middle-to-upper income brackets.
- **Self-Reporting Bias:** Metrics reflect parental perceptions of addiction and academic impact rather than objective academic records or clinical diagnoses.